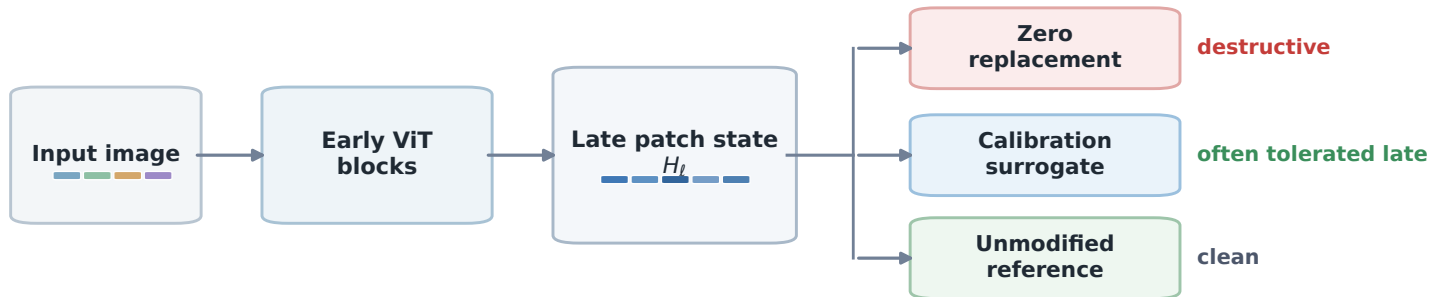


## (a) Activation substitution isolates what late patch states must preserve



Upstream image processing is unchanged; [CLS], token slots, sequence length, model weights, and downstream blocks remain fixed.

## (b) Geometry



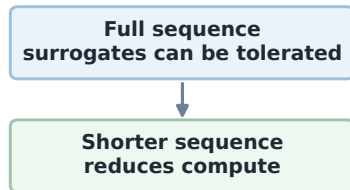
**Feature-coordinate identity and orientation matter.**

## (c) Diversity



**Complete replacement still requires token diversity.**

## (d) Boundary



but

**matched pruning  $\geq$  synthetic carrier**